CINNARIZINE

Motion sickness
Parkinsonism in elderly

CHEMICAL NAME (E)-1-(diphenylmethyl)-4-(3-phenylprop-2-en-1-yl)piperazine
CLASS Antihistamine and calcium-channel blocker (antivertigo)
TRADE NAMES Stugeron · Stunarone · Arlevert (with dimenhydrinate)

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Motion sickness (prevention).
- Vestibular disorders: vertigo, tinnitus, nausea (Ménière's).
- Peripheral vascular disease (higher doses, rarely).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** after meals.
- Motion sickness: 2 h before travel.

DOSAGES

- **Vestibular disorders:** 30 mg three times daily.
- **Motion sickness (adult):** 30 mg 2 h before travel, then 15 mg every 8 h during journey.
- **Children 5–12 yr:** half adult dose.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 2–4 h.
- Metabolised in liver (CYP2D6).
- Excreted in faeces and urine. **t½:** 3–6 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- **H1 antagonist** + blocks **calcium influx** in vestibular hair cells and vascular smooth muscle → ↓ vestibular stimulation, vasodilation.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Drowsiness.
- GI upset, weight gain.
- Dry mouth.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Extrapyramidal symptoms, parkinsonism, depression (elderly, long-term).
- Cholestatic jaundice (rare).
- Lichen planus-like skin reactions.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Parkinson's disease.
- Porphyria.
- **Caution:** elderly long-term use, hepatic or renal impairment.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Alcohol, CNS depressants:** ↑ sedation.
- **TCAs:** ↑ sedation.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Assess vertigo and nausea.
- Elderly: watch for tremor, rigidity, low mood — prefer short courses.
- Fall precautions.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- May cause drowsiness; avoid alcohol and driving.
- Report tremor or stiffness.
- Take after meals.

KEY POINTS

- Antihistamine + Ca^{2+} blocker for vertigo.
- Motion sickness prevention.
- Parkinsonism in elderly.
- Drowsiness.